



RELOCATION GUIDE

# Waikato

Kirikiroa (Hamilton)

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A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Waikato.

# Tertiary work and a house with a garden. Ninety minutes from Auckland.

The Waikato is the part of New Zealand that delights people who give it a look. It holds a major tertiary hospital, the country's longest river, a surf coast and the seat of the Māori King, all within an hour of a city where a family home is genuinely affordable.

**~185k**

people in Hamilton;  
~530k in the region

**425 km**

the Waikato, New  
Zealand's longest river

**15 min**

a typical Hamilton  
commute

**Same**

national pay as  
Auckland, on about half  
the housing cost

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

# Why people choose the Waikato

The Waikato's appeal is that the tertiary case mix, the short commute, the house and the coast can all be true at the same time.

Hamilton, Kirikiriroa, sits on a bend of the Waikato River. It is one of the youngest and fastest-growing cities in the country, and has spent a decade steadily becoming a better and better place to live: the riverside paths, the gardens, the food, the university.

Around it is farmland of a particular green that delights people in summer, threaded with small towns that each have their own character: horses at Cambridge, dairy at Morrinsville, coal and river at Huntly, the Kīngitanga at Ngāruawāhia.

## Five reasons people choose it

- ✓ Tertiary work without a tertiary city's costs: the complexity and referral base, and a house you can afford.
- ✓ You're in the middle of everything: Auckland ninety minutes north, the Bay of Plenty an hour east.
- ✓ A city on the rise, and residents who are proud to say so.
- ✓ The housing maths: families who found Auckland out of reach buy here comfortably, often with a garden and garage.
- ✓ Genuine breadth of practice: tertiary, rural and Māori health inside one organisation.



Hobbiton, at Matamata: one of the things people fly across the world for, within an hour of Hamilton.

## ○ Monday to Friday

~15 MIN COMMUTE

Fifteen minutes to the hospital from most of the city, and home in daylight for most of the year.

## ○ Wednesday

THE RIVER

A run or a ride on the riverside paths, which stretch for kilometres from the centre.

## ○ Friday

DINNER

In the centre, or in Cambridge down the expressway for a completely different evening.

## ○ Saturday

REACH

Raglan for the surf, Hamilton Gardens for the morning, or an hour to the caves, the lake or the coast.

## ○ Sunday

SLOW

Markets, the river, and the kind of unhurried afternoon a bigger city rarely gives you.

## WHO IT SUITS

### Clinicians who want both

Tertiary complexity and rural breadth in the same job, sometimes the same week.

### Families

A house, a garden, short commutes and a budget that stretches.

### People who fill their weekends

Surf, caves, lakes and mountains all inside a couple of hours.

## GOOD TO KNOW

### A river city with green at its heart

If you're looking for grand architecture, Hamilton isn't that. If you love a riverside run, beautiful gardens and green space everywhere, it could be a great fit.

### Make it home

People who settle in locally, rather than heading to Auckland every weekend, enjoy it most.

### Mild winters

Never truly cold, with misty mornings that usually clear by ten into crisp, calm days.

### A car opens up the region

Most households run one or two to make the most of the coast, lakes and mountains.

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### If you're comparing regions

The same value with a coastline at the door: the Bay of Plenty or Hawke's Bay. A compact, walkable city: Wellington. The widest range of roles: Auckland, ninety minutes up the expressway.



Native bush on a walking track, never far from town.



The koru, the unfurling fern frond, in any patch of bush.

## How the region is laid out

The Waikato runs from the Coromandel coast in the north-east to the King Country in the south, with Hamilton and the river down the middle. Rich farmland, with a surf coast on one side and a limestone cave system beneath part of it.



The rolling green of Waikato hill country.

### THE HUB

#### Hamilton & the river

The hospital, the university, the airport and most of the jobs, built along both banks. Older suburbs east, newer growth north.

### CAMBRIDGE & TE AWAMUTU

#### The Waipa towns

Cambridge is the country's equine centre and one of its prettiest small towns; Te Awamutu is a friendly working town with notably better value.

### TOWARDS AUCKLAND

#### North Waikato

Ngāruawāhia, Huntly and Te Kauwhata, growing quickly as Auckland pushes south.

### RAGLAN, 45 MIN

#### The west coast

Black-sand harbours, surf and art, and a village with a relaxed, creative streak.

## RURAL HEALTH COUNTRY

### The Coromandel & the south

Thames and the peninsula to the north-east; the King Country, Waitomo and Te Kūiti to the south.

#### Summer

DEC – FEB

Around 22–26°, warm and humid with long evenings. The coast is the obvious escape.

#### Autumn

MAR – MAY

Around 15–22°. Often the best season: settled days, cool nights, and the first misty mornings in May.

#### Winter

JUN – AUG

Around 7–15°, mild and green, with frosty mornings inland and rarely snow. A perfect season for the hot pools.

#### Spring

SEP – NOV

Around 12–20°, changeable and increasingly green. Lambs, blossom, the region at its most photogenic.

The local signature is fog. On still autumn and winter mornings the river flats fill with mist that can sit until mid-morning, beautiful from a riverside path. Allow a little extra time on the motorway and for early flights, and after a season it becomes part of the charm.

The river organises the city. It splits Hamilton in two, so work out which side the hospital is on relative to your shortlist of houses. The riverside walkways are the city's best amenity, continuous for miles in both directions.

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### The Kīngitanga matters here

Ngāruawāhia is the seat of the Māori King movement, and Tūrangawaewae Marae is one of the most significant places in the country. It is a living presence that shapes the region's institutions and its health services. Kirikiriroa is Hamilton's name in te reo Māori, and the Waikato is the awa, the river, that gives the region its name.

# Healthcare and work in the Waikato

Hamilton's tertiary hospital, run by Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora, serves the central North Island. What makes the Waikato distinctive is that hospital combined with an extensive rural network inside a single organisation.

## ~1m

**people in the tertiary catchment**

from the Coromandel to the King Country, and the Bay of Plenty for some services

## Same

**pay as Auckland**  
national collective agreements

## 90 min

**to Auckland's quaternary services**

### HAMILTON

#### The tertiary centre

Full secondary services for the city and tertiary services for the region. The case mix is broader and more complex than Hamilton alone would generate.

### COROMANDEL TO KING COUNTRY

#### Rural hospitals

Rural hospitals and community services with real generalist scope and considerable autonomy.

### MEDICINE, NURSING, ALLIED HEALTH

#### A teaching environment

Clinical training across disciplines, with strong university links. Supervision and teaching are a normal part of the job.

### ACROSS THE REGION

#### Māori health providers

A large Māori population and an established network of iwi and Māori providers. Working alongside them is part of practising here.

### MINUTES FROM THE PUBLIC CAMPUS

#### The private sector

Planned surgery, endoscopy and diagnostics. Hamilton is compact enough for a public list in the morning and a private one in the afternoon.

### CITY AND TOWNS

#### Imaging & aged care

Community radiology networks are a substantial employer for imaging staff; aged residential care employs nurses and therapists outside the acute roster.

## WHAT THE REGION GIVES YOU

### **Breadth, deliberately**

Many roles combine tertiary sessions with rural or outreach work.

### **Auckland close enough to matter**

Highly specialised work goes north, and at ninety minutes that partnership runs smoothly.

## GOOD TO KNOW

### **Regional thinking**

With a large region behind the hospital, transfer planning becomes second nature, and a skill you'll value.

### **A growing region**

One of the fastest-growing parts of the country, and growing demand means real opportunity to develop your career.



**If you're looking for big-city buzz, Hamilton isn't that. But people who move here for the numbers tend to stay for the life: the short commute, the river and the time it gives back.**

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## Everyday care, for you and your family

- ☐ Enrol with a GP as soon as you have an address. Demand is high and some books are closed, so starting early pays off.
- ☐ Find your nearest after-hours accident and medical clinic before you need it.
- ☐ Adult dental is private; it is free for under-18s.
- ☐ If cross-sector work is part of your plan, raise it early. Arrangements vary by specialty.

# Where to live in the Waikato

The Waikato gives you a choice most destinations don't: three genuinely different lives, all within forty-five minutes of the same hospital.

Decide first between city, town and coast. Then character or modern: Hamilton's loveliest streets are villas and 1930s bungalows around the lake, in Claudelands and in Hamilton East; its warmest, driest houses are in Flagstaff and Rototuna, built since the 1990s. Most people choose one style or the other. Finally, which side of the river?

## CENTRAL WEST · ~5 MIN

### Hamilton Lake

Character villas around Lake Rotoroa, a circuit half the city walks at weekends, and what most people call the city's best address.

## CENTRAL WEST · ~6 MIN

### Frankton

Great-value living close to the hospital, with a revived little main street. Character varies from street to street, so take a walk around before you sign.

## CENTRAL EAST · ~9-10 MIN

### Hamilton East & Claudelands

Some of the prettiest streets in the city, walkable to town. Claudelands is sought after, so homes move quickly.

## SOUTH EAST · ~10 MIN

### Hillcrest

Behind the university, with well-regarded schools and big sections. Popular with school-age families.

## NORTH · ~16-18 MIN

### Flagstaff & Rototuna

Modern, warm, well-insulated houses and purpose-built schools, with an easy commute across the city.

## WAIPA · ~25 MIN

### Cambridge

Tree-lined streets and a main street that wouldn't look out of place in England, and deservedly popular.

## ~25-30 MIN

### Te Awamutu & Ngāruawāhia

Friendly working towns with real communities and the best-value housing within commuting distance.

## WEST COAST · ~45 MIN

### Raglan

A black-sand harbour and a world-class left-hand break. A scenic, winding road in, and a beautiful place to come home to.



A weekend in Hamilton Gardens: free to enter, and where most residents take every visitor.

#### IF YOU REMEMBER THREE THINGS

- ✓ A four-bedroom house with a garden and garage is an ordinary Hamilton purchase, not an aspiration.
- ✓ Rent for six months first. It tells you whether you want the city, a town or the coast.
- ✓ Drive the northern growth suburbs on a weekday and on a Sunday, so you know the commute before committing.

# Getting around the Waikato

Hamilton is easy to drive and the region is easy to cross. The expressway made Auckland a predictable ninety minutes away.

10–20 min

most of Hamilton to the hospital

+10 min

what peak adds

~2 hrs

door to door to Auckland Airport

Hamilton is flat and gridded with good arterials, and parking is easier and cheaper than in Auckland or Wellington. The river paths make cycling a genuine option for many hospital staff, and the on-road network keeps growing. Buses cover the main suburban routes and the university, with regional links to Cambridge, Te Awamutu, Ngāruawāhia and Huntly.

Te Huia, the weekday passenger rail service between Hamilton and Auckland, is comfortable and relaxed, and suits anyone who would rather read or work than drive. Most regular travellers take the car, so you have both options.

### Do you need a car?

- ✓

In central Hamilton, perhaps not. Elsewhere, a car makes life easy, and many households run two.
- ✓

The river is crossed at a handful of bridges, so living on your hospital's side keeps commutes short.
- ✓

Raglan, the Coromandel, the caves and the lakes are all car trips, and exploring them is half the joy of living here.
- ✓

On misty autumn and winter mornings, allow fifteen extra minutes and take it gently.

| FROM HAMILTON       | DRIVING TIME     |
|---------------------|------------------|
| Cambridge           | 20–25 min        |
| Raglan              | 45 min           |
| Rotorua or Tauranga | ~1 hr 15–1 hr 30 |
|                     |                  |

| FROM HAMILTON            | DRIVING TIME     |
|--------------------------|------------------|
| Auckland (southern edge) | 90 min           |
| Taupō                    | ~1 hr 45–2 hours |
| Ruapehu ski fields       | 2.5–3.5 hours    |



Auckland, ninety minutes up the expressway, or a relaxed ride on Te Huia.



Mount Maunganui, about an hour and a half east by car.

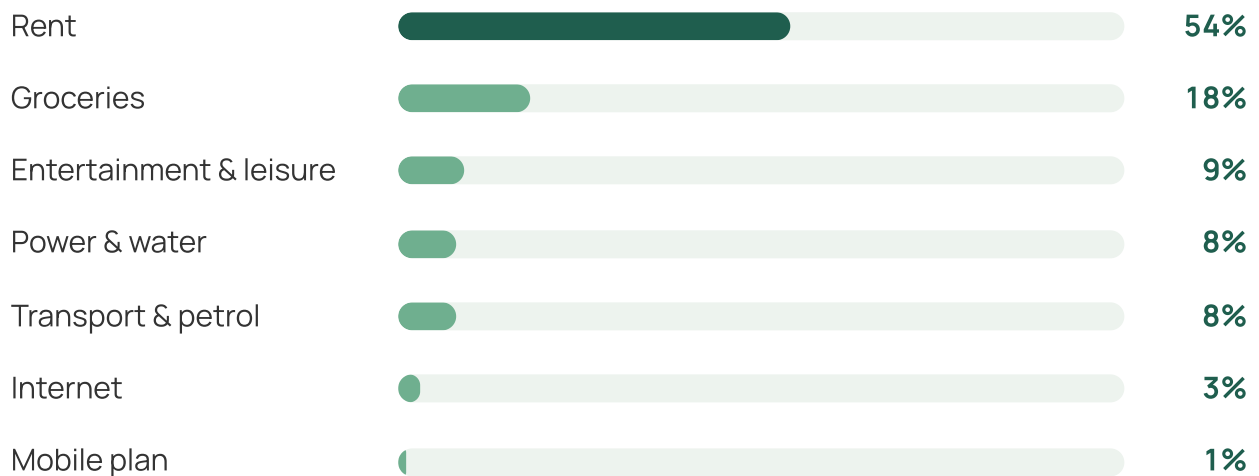


The Emerald Lakes in Tongariro National Park, a long weekend's drive south.

# What it costs to live here

Health New Zealand pays national agreement rates, so your salary is the one you'd earn in Auckland, ninety minutes up the road, where the same house costs roughly twice as much. We don't print prices; proportions move slowly and prices move every quarter.

## Where a month goes



one person on a mid-range budget; proportions, not amounts

Rent takes just over half the month, on a contract paying exactly what it would pay in Auckland. Run the comparison almost everyone runs: your pay doesn't change, your housing cost roughly halves, and your commute drops from forty minutes to fifteen. Add a second car to the budget, and big-city nights out are an easy ninety minutes up the road.

For a single clinician the sums are good. For a family buying a house they are transformative, usually measured in years of mortgage rather than dollars a week.



Space, a garden and a garage: what the Waikato's housing advantage looks like.

#### TE AWAMUTU & NGĀRUAWĀHIA

##### Even better value

Meaningfully cheaper again than Hamilton, and both within half an hour of the hospital.

#### CAMBRIDGE & RAGLAN

##### The sought-after towns

Cambridge for the town, Raglan for the coast. Both are priced for their lovely settings.

#### TWO CARS

##### Budget for the driving

A thirty-minute commute each way is roughly an extra tank a fortnight.

#### POWER

##### Keep it dry

Heating costs are moderate; a dehumidifier keeps an older villa cosy and is a sensible purchase.

#### Three costs to plan for

- ☐ Flights home: long-haul goes from Auckland, so plan for the drive, parking and an extra day.
- ☐ Adult dental is private, so set aside a little for regular check-ups.
- ☐ Setting up: bond, rent in advance, a car, whiteware and furniture. Budgeting generously for the first two months makes the start smoother.
- ☐ For today's numbers, use Tenancy Services market rent, Numbeo or Expatistan against the city you're leaving.



#### SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

## What I tell people about the Waikato

The Waikato is the region I most love introducing people to. If you want tertiary referral work and genuine rural medicine in the same week, very few places in New Zealand give you both.

The clinicians who settle here move on the numbers and stay for the life: a fifteen-minute commute, a garden the children can actually use, Raglan on a Saturday. The ones who thrive treat it as home rather than a base for Auckland. Live here properly for a year, and you'll understand why so many people happily stay.

### Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



A garden the children can actually use, and a barbecue on a summer evening.

# Food, culture and everyday life

Hamilton's food scene has grown up over the past decade, because a young city with a university and a lot of new arrivals demands good food.

## THE CENTRE

### Victoria Street

The main strip parallel to the river, revitalised, with the Waikato Museum at one end.

## GREY STREET

### Hamilton East

A village feel, good coffee and small restaurants, plus great-value, genuinely good Asian food at the university end.

## 20–25 MIN

### Cambridge

Delis, bakeries and a couple of destination restaurants. A real food town.

## 45 MIN

### Raglan

Surf-town food: cafés, bakeries, fish and chips on the wharf and the best coffee with a view in the region.

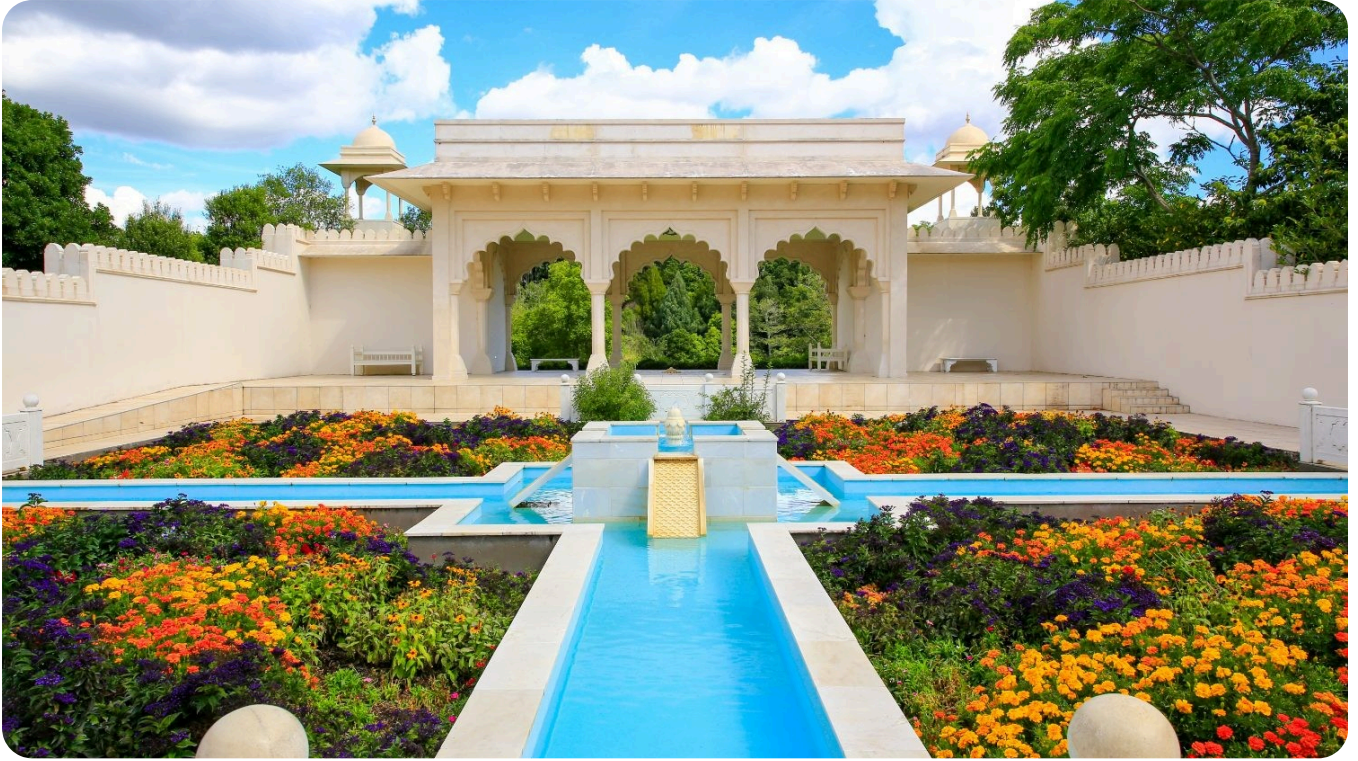
## WEEKLY

### Markets & gate sales

The farmers' market draws on some of the most productive farmland in the country.

Hamilton Gardens deserves its own paragraph. A series of enclosed themed gardens, Italian, Japanese, Indian, Māori and more, free to enter and busy all year, with an arts festival each summer. Visitors are always delighted by it, and most residents end up taking every guest there.

Supermarket prices are among the more reasonable in the country; you are surrounded by farms. The student population and a long-established migrant community mean South Asian, East Asian and Middle Eastern grocers are all here.



The Indian Char Bagh garden at Hamilton Gardens, named International Garden of the Year in 2014. Free to enter.

### Culture and events

- ✓ The Waikato Museum and ArtsPost galleries sit by the river, with a good theatre, an events centre and a regional stadium.
- ✓ Cambridge and Raglan run arts scenes out of proportion to their size.
- ✓ The university brings talks, music and a steady flow of people.
- ✓ Auckland's big concerts, galleries and international sport are an easy ninety minutes up the expressway.

## Weekends and the outdoors

Nowhere else in New Zealand puts a surf coast, a cave system, a volcanic lake, a peninsula of white-sand beaches and a major city all within two hours of the same front door.



Glowworms at Waitomo, an hour south of Hamilton.



### Lake Karāpiro & the river trails

~20 MIN

Rowing, cycling and the Te Awa river ride towards Cambridge.



### Raglan

~45 MIN

Manu Bay's long left-hand point break, a harbour, Karioi to climb and fish and chips on the wharf.



### Waitomo

~1 HOUR

Limestone caves lit by glowworms, black-water rafting and serious caving if you want it.



### Rotorua

~1 HR 15

Geothermal parks, hot pools, forest mountain biking and Māori cultural tourism.



## The Coromandel

~1.5-2 HOURS

Cathedral Cove, Hot Water Beach and bays that are lively at New Year and peaceful the rest of the time.



## Taupō & Ruapehu

~2-3.5 HOURS

The lake, the trout, the Tongariro Crossing and the North Island's ski fields.

### FREE

#### Hamilton Gardens

Themed gardens, river walks and summer festival shows. Most residents go back again and again.

### ON YOUR DOORSTEP

#### The river and Te Awa

Walking and cycling paths along the Waikato, including the Te Awa trail towards Cambridge.

### SATURDAY & SUNDAY

#### Markets and cafés

Farmers' markets in Hamilton and the Waipa towns, then brunch in Hamilton East or Cambridge.

### KIDS' FAVOURITE

#### Zoo and Waiwhakareke

Hamilton Zoo sits beside Waiwhakareke, a native bush restoration park with walking tracks.

### YEAR-ROUND

#### Sport, watched and played

Junior club sport on Saturday mornings, Super Rugby at the city stadium, rowing at Karāpiro.

### ANNUAL

#### Big local events

Balloons over Waikato in autumn and Fieldays at Mystery Creek, one of the largest agricultural shows in the southern hemisphere.



Through the arch at Cathedral Cove, on the Coromandel.



Marokopa Falls in the King Country.



The marina where the Waikato leaves Lake Taupō.

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**Surf at forty-five minutes, caves at an hour,  
the Coromandel and Auckland at ninety,  
and a house with a garden to come home to.**

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Cambridge is the centre of New Zealand's thoroughbred industry and home to the national cycling velodrome, and Lake Karāpiro hosts international rowing. If any of those are your sport, this is one of the best places in the country to pursue it seriously.

The coast is a short, scenic drive away, and Auckland's big-city calendar is up the expressway. What you get is reach, space, and the time and money to enjoy both.



A Coromandel beach out of season: peaceful for most of the year.



Forest trails, the kind of ride that fills a Saturday morning.



A tent by the lake: summer weekends need very little planning.

### Enjoying the outdoors safely

- ☐ Raglan and the west coast have strong currents. Swim between the flags.
- ☐ The UV is strong even when it feels cool, so pack sunscreen and a hat.
- ☐ Stick to marked tracks in the caves at Waitomo and in Rotorua's thermal areas.

## Day trips and weekends away

Hamilton sits in the middle of the North Island's best weekends: the Coromandel and the Bay of Plenty to the east, Rotorua and Taupō to the south-east, and the mountains of Tongariro beyond.

Within about an hour and a half you can be on the beach at Mount Maunganui, in the hot pools at Rotorua or at the glow-worm caves at Waitomo. Taupō's lake and Huka Falls are under two hours away, and Whakapapa and Tūroa on Mount Ruapehu, the North Island's ski fields, about three.

Auckland, ninety minutes north, adds the international airport, concerts and big-city shopping. Hamilton Airport has domestic flights, so Wellington and the South Island are easy weekends too.

| GETTING TO                                            | ROUGHLY        | WHY GO                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Raglan (Ngarunui Beach)</b>                        | ~45 min        | The nearest surf beach, with patrolled swimming in summer      |
| <b>Mount Maunganui</b>                                | ~1.5 hrs       | A calm-to-surf ocean beach and the walk up Mauao               |
| <b>Ski fields (Whakapapa &amp; Tūroa, Mt Ruapehu)</b> | ~3 hrs         | The North Island's ski fields; a day trip or a weekend         |
| <b>Auckland (nearest major city)</b>                  | ~1.5 hrs       | Concerts, museums, shopping and international sport            |
| <b>Auckland Airport</b>                               | ~1.5 hrs       | International flights; Hamilton Airport (~15 min) for domestic |
| <b>Hobbiton, Matamata</b>                             | ~45 min        | The movie set, in rolling farmland                             |
| <b>Rotorua</b>                                        | ~1 hr 15       | Geothermal parks, hot pools, the Redwoods and Māori culture    |
| <b>Taupō</b>                                          | ~1 hr 45–2 hrs | The lake, Huka Falls and the Tongariro Crossing beyond         |
| <b>Hahei &amp; Cathedral Cove</b>                     | ~2–2.5 hrs     | The Coromandel's best-known beach walk                         |

~1.5 HRS

### Mount Maunganui & Tauranga

Walk up Mauao, swim at the main beach and finish in the hot saltwater pools at its foot.

~1 HR 15

### Rotorua

Steaming geothermal valleys, the Redwoods treewalk, the gondola and luge, and a hāngī at a Māori cultural village.

~1 HR 45–2 HRS

### Taupō & Huka Falls

Swim, kayak or fish on New Zealand's largest lake, then watch the Waikato River thunder through Huka Falls.

~3 HRS

### Tongariro & Ruapehu

The Tongariro Alpine Crossing in summer, skiing and snowboarding at Whakapapa and Tūroa in winter.

~45 MIN

### Hobbiton

The Shire, kept exactly as it was filmed. The visit every overseas guest asks for.

~1.5–2.5 HRS

### The Coromandel

Hot Water Beach, Cathedral Cove, Pauanui and Whangamatā: the region's own summer coast.

~1.5 HRS

### A day in Auckland

The museum, the harbour ferries and a show, back in Hamilton the same night. Te Huia, the passenger train, is an alternative to the drive.



The boardwalk onto Pauanui beach, on the Coromandel's east coast.



A snow day at Whakapapa on Mount Ruapehu, about three hours south.



Geothermal colour in the Rotorua area, about an hour and a quarter away.

## Schools and family life

Space, gardens, short commutes, a full range of schooling, and both beaches and mountains within a couple of hours. The household budget stretches a long way.

A four-bedroom house with a garden in a good Hamilton suburb costs what a two-bedroom apartment costs in Auckland. For families this is usually the deciding number, and it buys space: a garden, a garage for the bikes, and short commutes that leave time for the school run.

Children's weekends are easy to fill: Hamilton Zoo, the lake playground at Hamilton Lake, the Waterworld aquatic centre, free libraries and an enormous junior sport scene. The city is flat, so biking to school and to friends' houses is normal.

### What the schools are like

- ✓ Most children attend state schools. There are also state-integrated schools, often with a church character, and independent schools in and around Hamilton and Cambridge.
- ✓ Children usually start at five. Primary is Years 1–6, intermediate Years 7–8 and secondary Years 9–13.
- ✓ Many Hamilton schools run enrolment schemes, or zones. Check the exact address is in-zone before you sign a lease.
- ✓ Every school has an Education Review Office report, free to read at [ero.govt.nz](http://ero.govt.nz).
- ✓ For three- to five-year-olds, 20 Hours ECE funds up to 20 hours a week at participating early childhood centres and kindergartens.

Hillcrest, Flagstaff and Rototuna are popular with school-age families; Rototuna has purpose-built modern schools. Long-established secondary schools include Hamilton Boys' High School and Hamilton Girls' High School, and Cambridge and Te Awamutu have their own high schools.

For older students, the University of Waikato and Wintec, the regional polytechnic, are both in Hamilton, so many teenagers can study without leaving home.



The walk down to Cathedral Cove, an easy family day out.

### Things you only learn once you're here

- ✓ It is a region, not a city: Cambridge, Raglan, Te Awamutu and Thames are all genuine options.
- ✓ Auckland is close enough for a day out, and Hamilton has everything for a full life of its own.
- ✓ Rural health is a large part of the work, if you want it.
- ✓ The river is the city's best feature, and residents mention it first.
- ✓ The morning mist is lovely, and usually clears by ten.
- ✓ Housing goes a long way.

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**The Waikato's advantage is position: ninety minutes from Auckland, an hour from the Bay of Plenty, forty-five minutes from a surf coast, and a fraction of the cost of any of them.**

# Your Waikato address book

Hamilton has one of New Zealand's best-organised settlement networks, centred on the Settlement Centre Waikato hub in Claudelands. It also has active Filipino and Muslim associations, two gurdwaras and a wide spread of churches. Cambridge and Te Awamutu are close enough to use all of it. English Language Partners also runs a classroom in Te Awamutu.

## COUNCILS

### Hamilton City Council

Rates, rubbish, libraries, pools and Hamilton Gardens  
[hamilton.govt.nz](http://hamilton.govt.nz)

### Waipā District Council

Cambridge, Te Awamutu and the towns south of the city  
[waipadc.govt.nz](http://waipadc.govt.nz)

### Waikato District Council

Raglan, Ngāruawāhia, Huntly, Pōkeno and the north of the region  
[waikatodistrict.govt.nz](http://waikatodistrict.govt.nz)

### Waikato Regional Council

Regional council: public transport planning, environment and civil defence  
[waikatoregion.govt.nz](http://waikatoregion.govt.nz)

## GETTING AROUND

### Busit

Hamilton's buses and the regional commuter routes, with the Bee Card  
[busit.co.nz](http://busit.co.nz)

## SETTLING IN & EXPLORING

### Settlement Centre Waikato

Migrant and refugee settlement support in Hamilton  
[settlementcentre.org.nz](http://settlementcentre.org.nz)

### Department of Conservation

Tracks, huts and campsites, from Pirongia to the Coromandel  
[doc.govt.nz](http://doc.govt.nz)

## COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

### Settlement Centre Waikato

Purpose-built ethnic community hub with settlement services, English classes and community venues under one roof; 46G Boundary Rd, Claudelands  
**07 853 2192** [scw.org.nz](http://scw.org.nz)

### HMS Trust (Hamilton Multicultural Services)

Settlement support for migrants and former refugees: New Kiwis service, housing navigation, Passport 2 Drive, community connectors  
**07 853 2192** [hmstrust.org.nz](http://hmstrust.org.nz)

### English Language Partners Waikato

English classes (free for residents), home tutors, workplace English, IELTS prep; classrooms across Hamilton and in Te Awamutu  
**07 853 2188**  
[englishlanguage.org.nz/centres/hamilton](http://englishlanguage.org.nz/centres/hamilton)

### Waikato Filipino Association

Hamilton's Filipino association; Kalayaan and Pasko events, sports leagues, Pinoy Palengke and cultural shows  
[waikatofilipino.org.nz](http://waikatofilipino.org.nz)

### Waikato Muslim Association

Hamilton's regional Muslim association (a FIANZ member); contact for mosque and Friday prayer details  
[fianz.com/fianz-constituents](http://fianz.com/fianz-constituents)

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### Hamilton City Council: Welcoming Communities

Newcomer guide to Hamilton Kirikiriroa, the New Settlers Focus Group and community network meetings

07 838 6699

[hamilton.govt.nz/community-support-and-funding/welcoming-communities](https://hamilton.govt.nz/community-support-and-funding/welcoming-communities)

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### Waikato Refugee Forum

Advocacy and support for former-refugee communities, based at Settlement Centre Waikato

[scw.org.nz](https://scw.org.nz)

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### Ministry for Ethnic Communities directory

Search for Indian, Malayali, South African and other associations in the Waikato

[ethniccommunities.govt.nz/community-directory](https://ethniccommunities.govt.nz/community-directory)

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## FACEBOOK & ONLINE GROUPS

### Waikato Filipino Association (Facebook)

Event notices and community news for Filipinos in Hamilton

[facebook.com/waikatofilipino](https://facebook.com/waikatofilipino)

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### HMS Trust on Facebook

Settlement events, workshops and the Weave Ethnic Market; the Facebook link is on the HMS Trust website

[hmstrust.org.nz](https://hmstrust.org.nz)

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## PLACES OF WORSHIP

### Catholic Diocese of Hamilton

Find a parish and mass times across Hamilton, Cambridge and Te Awamutu; St Mary's Cathedral is in Hamilton East

07 856 6989 [cdh.org.nz/mass-times](https://cdh.org.nz/mass-times)

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### St Peter's Cathedral (Anglican)

Hamilton's Anglican cathedral, built in 1916, on the west side of the river

### Hamilton New Zealand Temple (Latter-day Saints)

LDS temple at Temple View, Hamilton; meetinghouses across the region

[churchofjesuschrist.org](https://churchofjesuschrist.org)

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### Gurdwara Mata Sahib Kaur

Sikh gurdwara at 23 Bryant Rd, Te Rapa, Hamilton

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### New Zealand Sikh Society Hamilton

Sikh gurdwara at 6391 Te Rapa Rd, Horotiu, just north of Hamilton

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### ISKCON (Hare Krishna) Hamilton

Hindu (Krishna) temple community in Hamilton

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### Waikato Muslim Association

Hamilton's mosque community; FIANZ lists contacts for prayer times

[fianz.com/fianz-constituents](https://fianz.com/fianz-constituents)

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## HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

### Asian grocers near the university and city centre

Several well-stocked Asian stores serve Hamilton's student population around Hillcrest, Hamilton East and the CBD

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### MandiBazaar

Online Indian grocery delivered nationwide

[mandibazaar.co.nz](https://mandibazaar.co.nz)

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### Halal meat and kosher food

No halal butcher or kosher source was confirmed. Ask the Waikato Muslim Association about halal, and order kosher food from Auckland

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## SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

### Pak'nSave

Cheapest big chain; several Hamilton stores, plus Te Awamutu

[paknsave.co.nz](https://paknsave.co.nz)

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### Woolworths

Stores across Hamilton, Cambridge and Te Awamutu;  
good online ordering  
[woolworths.co.nz](https://www.woolworths.co.nz)

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### New World

Several Hamilton stores plus Cambridge and Te Awamutu; better fresh and specialty ranges  
[newworld.co.nz](https://www.newworld.co.nz)

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### Hamilton Farmers Market

Weekly farmers market with Waikato produce;  
Cambridge and Raglan run their own

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### Weave Ethnic Market

HMS Trust's multicultural food and craft market  
[hmstrust.org.nz](https://www.hmstrust.org.nz)

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## SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

### Find a school (Education Counts)

Every school in Hamilton, Cambridge and Te Awamutu,  
with enrolment zones (most Hamilton schools are  
zoned)  
[educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school](https://www.educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school)

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### School uniforms

Most schools sell uniforms (new and second-hand)  
through their own uniform shop or PTA; ask the school  
office when you enrol

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### Hamilton City Libraries

Seven branches including Central, Rototuna, Hillcrest  
and Glenview; kids' corner, teen space, IELTS and  
language learning tools  
[hamiltonlibraries.co.nz](https://www.hamiltonlibraries.co.nz)

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### Plunket

Free support for under-fives and parents; 24/7  
PlunketLine  
**0800 933 922** [plunket.org.nz](https://www.plunket.org.nz)

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### Playcentre

Parent-led play sessions for under-sixes; use the map  
to find Waikato centres  
[playcentre.org.nz/find-your-centre](https://www.playcentre.org.nz/find-your-centre)

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### Parents Centre

Antenatal classes and parent coffee groups  
[parentcentres.org.nz](https://www.parentcentres.org.nz)

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## HOUSING & AREAS

### Trade Me Property: Waikato rentals

Main rental listings site for Hamilton and the towns  
[trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/waikato](https://www.trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/waikato)

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### realestate.co.nz

Homes for sale and rent across the Waikato  
[realestate.co.nz](https://www.realestate.co.nz)

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### Tenancy Services market rent tool

Check what's fair for a suburb before you apply  
[tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent](https://www.tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent)

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### Trade Me flatmates wanted

Rooms in shared houses, useful for your first weeks  
[trademe.co.nz/a/property/flatmates-wanted](https://www.trademe.co.nz/a/property/flatmates-wanted)

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### Hamilton property search

Council rates and property information for any  
Hamilton address  
[hamilton.govt.nz/property-rates-and-building/property/property-search](https://www.hamilton.govt.nz/property-rates-and-building/property/property-search)

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### Waipā District Council

Rates and services for Cambridge and Te Awamutu  
[waipadc.govt.nz](https://www.waipadc.govt.nz)

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### HMS Trust housing navigation

Help for newcomers finding and keeping a rental  
[hmstrust.org.nz](https://www.hmstrust.org.nz)

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## GETTING AROUND

### Busit

Hamilton city buses (Orbiter, Comet, Meteor) and  
regional buses to Cambridge, Te Awamutu and beyond;  
journey planner  
**0800 205 305** [busit.co.nz](https://www.busit.co.nz)

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### Bee Card

Tap-on fare card for Busit buses  
[beecard.co.nz](https://www.beecard.co.nz)

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### **Te Huia train**

Daily Hamilton (Frankton, Rotokauri) to Auckland Strand service via Huntly, Pukekohe and Puhinui (for Auckland Airport)

**0800 205 305   [tehuia.train.co.nz](https://tehuia.train.co.nz)**

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### **Hamilton Airport**

Domestic flights plus Jetstar to Sydney and the Gold Coast

**[hamiltonairport.co.nz](https://hamiltonairport.co.nz)**

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### **InterCity**

Coaches from Hamilton to Auckland, Rotorua, Tauranga and Wellington

**[intercity.co.nz](https://intercity.co.nz)**

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### **HMS Trust Passport 2 Drive**

Driving lessons and licence support for newcomers

**[hmstrust.org.nz](https://hmstrust.org.nz)**

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### **NZ Transport Agency: driver licences**

Rules for converting an overseas licence; AA centres in Hamilton handle licensing

**[nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences](https://nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences)**

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## **COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS**

### **Numbeo: Hamilton**

Crowd-sourced cost of living for Hamilton, to compare with your current city

**[numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Hamilton-New-Zealand](https://numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Hamilton-New-Zealand)**

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### **Tenancy Services market rent**

Actual bond-lodged rents by suburb

**[tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent](https://tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent)**

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### **Stats NZ**

Official price indexes and household spending figures

**[stats.govt.nz](https://stats.govt.nz)**

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### **Powerswitch**

Compare power plans for your Waikato address

**[powerswitch.org.nz](https://powerswitch.org.nz)**

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### **Sorted budget tool**

Free, independent budgeting calculator

**[sorted.org.nz/tools/budget-planner](https://sorted.org.nz/tools/budget-planner)**

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### **Checked October 2026**

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

# Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

## EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

### Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

**111**

### Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

**0800 611 116**

### Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

**1737**

### National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

**0800 764 766**

### PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

**0800 933 922**

## VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

### Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

**[immigration.govt.nz](https://immigration.govt.nz)**

### Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

**[iaa.govt.nz](https://iaa.govt.nz)**

### Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

**[health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions](https://health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions)**

### Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

**[nursingcouncil.org.nz](https://nursingcouncil.org.nz)**

### Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

**[mcnz.org.nz](https://mcnz.org.nz)**

## HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

### Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

**[tewhatuora.govt.nz](https://tewhatuora.govt.nz)**

### Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

**[healthpoint.co.nz](https://healthpoint.co.nz)**

### ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

**[acc.co.nz](https://acc.co.nz)**

## SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

### Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

**[educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school](https://educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school)**

### Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

**[ero.govt.nz](https://ero.govt.nz)**

### Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

**[parents.education.govt.nz](https://parents.education.govt.nz)**

## MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

### Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver  
[ird.govt.nz](https://ird.govt.nz)

### Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area  
[tenancy.govt.nz](https://tenancy.govt.nz)

### NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence  
[nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences](https://nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences)

### Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area  
[powerswitch.org.nz](https://powerswitch.org.nz)

### Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools  
[sorted.org.nz](https://sorted.org.nz)

### MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand  
[mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz](https://mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz)

## SETTLING IN

### Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question  
**0800 367 222** [cab.org.nz](https://cab.org.nz)

### Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities  
[ethniccommunities.govt.nz](https://ethniccommunities.govt.nz)

### Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings  
[doc.govt.nz](https://doc.govt.nz)



### Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

# Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

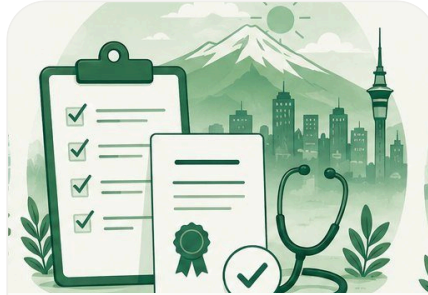
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



## STEP 1

### Discovery call

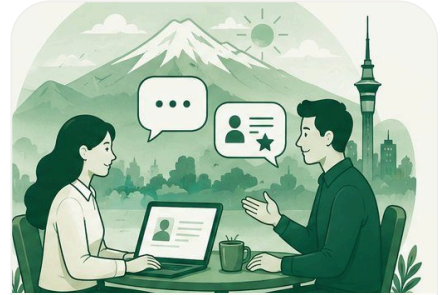
A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



## STEP 2

### Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



## STEP 3

### Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



## STEP 4

### Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



## STEP 5

### Visa & relocation guidance

Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



## STEP 6

### Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.

— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

# Picture yourself in Waikato. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



**Ethicare Resourcing**

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